



Midterm Exam Reconciliation

Introductory Psychology

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1 Background

The midterm exam of any class is likely one of the first substantial challenges a student faces during a course. This course is no different, and you may have found the midterm exam to be fairly difficult. It is normal to feel a sense of dissatisfaction or tough realization after the exam grades are posted. Many students perform worse than you may have expected based on your preparation, and this feeling can be crushing and painful.

First and foremost, I want to assure you that, regardless of your exam grade, I am not upset, angry, or disappointed, and still believe you can succeed in this course.

While the exam is meant to indicate your current ability in the content, it is not necessarily deterministic as to what you can still accomplish. Rather than let it be remembered as a failure, I'd like to treat it as a way to learn from mistakes and improve going forward.

2 Purpose

The word 'reconcile' means several different things, but I focus on these [two definitions from Merriam-Webster Dictionary](#):

To restore to friendship or harmony, to settle or resolve

To make consistent or congruous

I provide this midterm 'reconciliation' assignment as a way to help students grow and learn from the results of the midterm exam, while also trying to make sure that you (the students) and I (the instructor) maintain a healthy rapport moving forward. This process has four primary purposes:

1. Allow students a chance to earn points back so that the midterm exam performance is not an insurmountable obstacle to getting a passing grade at the end of the semester
2. Help students see where the correct information to questions could be found in the lectures and in the guided notes. I want this process to help you better focus your study, reading, and review as we continue in the semester. I also want to make sure students feel like the content that was tested upon was also actually covered in the lectures and notes
3. Show a gesture of goodwill from me (the instructor) to help students see that I desire *growth*, not perfection
4. Help correct misunderstandings or confusion naturally by re-working the logic of each question and using your resources to re-learn forgotten information

3 Assignment Structure

This assignment will allow you to 'earn back' **up to half** of the points you lost on the midterm exam. This is especially beneficial for those with low initial scores. For illustrative example:

Example 1: If you got a 50/100 (F) on the midterm exam, you lost 50 points on the exam. Thus, you could get back up to 25 points for a maximum possible score of 75/100 (C). In total, you could go from 50% $\rightarrow$ 75%, $F \rightarrow C$ on the exam.

Example 2: If you got an 82/100 (B-) on the midterm exam, you lost 18 points on the exam. Thus, you could get back up to 9 points for a maximum possible score of 91/100 (A-). In total, you could go from 82% $\rightarrow$ 91%, $B- \rightarrow A-$ on the exam.

However, to earn any points at all, you must follow the [Instructions](#) exactly and fully. Failure to adequately follow the instructions may result in being ineligible to earn any points back. Please take your time and ensure you have met each criterion and step. This is likely to be a time-consuming assignment, especially for those who have many questions to correct.

! Important

All syllabus and university policies on academic integrity, plagiarism, and other forms of misconduct apply to this assignment. Please review them if you are unfamiliar. **Any evidence of confabulation, AI hallucinations, or other non-genuine work will automatically disqualify this work from receiving credit, bar the student from any further extra credit in the course, and will be referred to academic integrity for discipline.** You should not copy and paste any part of this document into any other tool or program.

4 Instructions

*All parts (1 through 5) below **must** be completed in order to earn any credit on this assignment*

1. Re-write / paraphrase in your own words the [Background](#) and [Purpose](#) for this assignment. Put another way, I want you to tell me *why* I have given this opportunity, and explain what the entire purpose of this is. This does not necessarily need to be long, but you should try to adequately cover the 4 main purpose points I gave above
2. Briefly, write to tell me *why you* are completing this reconciliation assignment - you can be honest.
3. This is the bulk of the assignment - For **each** of the questions you got **wrong** on the midterm exam, do the following steps:

- Write the entire question text, e.g., “The _____ places less emphasis on research and more emphasis on application of therapeutic skills”
- Write what entire answer you originally gave that was incorrect, e.g., “Dissertation”
- Write what entire answer was actually correct, e.g., “PsyD”
- *Explain* why the correct answer is indeed correct, and *cite* either what page of the guided notes this information appeared on OR a time stamp in the module lecture video where I explained this information, e.g., “I forgot that dissertations are the really long paper written at the end of a doctoral program and are focused on research. The correct answer was PsyD (Doctor of Psychology degree) because that form of doctoral training is more focused on clinical skill building. This was covered on pages 15 and 16 of the module 1 guided notes.”

In total, here is an example of what I’d expect for part 3 for each incorrect question:

Original Question: “The _____ places less emphasis on research and more emphasis on application of therapeutic skills”

Incorrect Answer: “Dissertation”

Correct Answer: “PsyD”

Explanation: I forgot that dissertations are the really long paper written at the end of a doctoral program and are focused on research. The correct answer was PsyD (Doctor of Psychology degree) because that form of doctoral training is more focused on clinical skill building. This was covered on pages 15 and 16 of the module 1 guided notes.

1. At the end, please write and explain whether you thought this practice was helpful to helping you understand your mistakes on the exam
2. You must schedule a brief meeting with me or stop by during office hours to discuss this work you’ve done with me. Please reach out to me via email once you are at this step, and we can coordinate a good time and way to meet prior to me assigning points in the Blackboard gradebook. I will not give points until we have met.

You will earn 1 point back for each corrected question on part 3. You may do as few or as many questions as you’d like.